

America Dominates

The 1960s saw a major change in the design of light aircraft. The fabric-covered taildragger gave way to all-metal machines with tricycle undercarriages. Engines changed too—the radial and inverted inline configuration being superseded by air-cooled, horizontally opposed motors of four, six, or eight cylinders. The introduction of the solid-state VHF omnidirectional receivers (VOR) also made navigation in poor weather easier.

▷ Cessna 150A 1961

Origin USA

Engine 100 hp Continental O-200 air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 162 mph (259 km/h)

One of the most famous trainers of all time, the 150/152 series is still in use all over the world, 45 years after the prototype first flew.



▽ Cessna 172E Skyhawk 1964

Origin USA

Engine 145 hp Continental O-300 air-cooled flat-6

Top speed 125 mph (201 km/h)

Quite simply the most produced light aircraft in history, the Cessna 172 was the logical progression for any pilot who had learned to fly in either a C150 or C152. The type first flew in 1957, and remains in production today.



△ Beech S35 Bonanza 1965

Origin USA

Engine 285 hp Continental O-520 air-cooled flat-6

Top speed 175 mph (281 km/h)

Instantly recognizable by its V-tail, the Bonanza first flew in 1947. More than 17,000 Bonanzas have been built (not all V-tails), and the aircraft has the longest unbroken production run of any airplane in history.



△ Alon A-2 Aircoupe 1966

Origin USA

Engine 95 hp Continental C-90 air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 95 mph (152 km/h)

The Alon A-2 was descended from the classic 1941 Ercoupe, although (unlike the Ercoupe) it was fitted with a conventional three-axis control system. A four-seat version was built, but never entered production.

▽ Scintex Super Emeraude CP1310-C3 1965

Origin France

Engine 100 hp Continental O-200 air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 115 mph (185 km/h)

Designed by Claude Piel, the Super Emeraude was built by both homebuilders and factories in France, England, and South Africa. The type of engines fitted also varied, with Continental, Lycoming, and Potez motors being used.



▷ Piper PA-28 Cherokee 1966

Origin USA

Engine 150 hp Lycoming O-320 air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 124 mph (200 km/h)

Piper's counterpoint to Cessna's 172, the PA-28 went into production in 1960 and is still being built today. It eventually spawned a wide range of aircraft, from two-seat trainers to turbocharged four-seat tourers.



△ Cessna 401 1966

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 325 hp Continental TSIO-520 turbocharged air-cooled flat-6

Top speed 224 mph (360 km/h)

Developed from the Cessna 411, the 401 was unpressurized and thus easier to maintain than pressurized machines. It proved to be popular with small airlines as a "feeder-liner."

